

KISVEI RAV TZADOK

רסיסי לילה

Resisei Layla

An Interlinear Hebrew-English Edition
with Annotated Sources and Cross-References

Volume I · Simanim 1–42

AKIVA PUBLISHING

Introduction to Volume One

Volume I gathers the opening forty-two simanim of Resisei Layla and introduces the central spiritual vocabulary that recurs throughout the work. The volume opens with Torah as companionship within the restlessness of this world, then turns to the interaction of intellect and will, the life of the soul, prayer, humility, faith, fear of Heaven, song, sacred time, kindness, love, awe, and deveikut.

A sustained theme is the movement from concealment to revelation. Rav Tzadok repeatedly treats darkness, deficiency, distraction, and opposing forces not merely as obstacles, but as the setting in which a deeper light can emerge. That pattern appears in discussions of prayer and intention, the relation of Torah to imagination, the coexistence of opposing views within living Torah, and the ways in which holiness becomes fixed in the heart through memory, practice, and sacred time.

Purim and Amalek form a major axis of the middle portion of the volume. Simanim 18–24 explore the lot, exile, Malchut, Shushan Purim, restraint, divine mitzvot, and the emergence of light from darkness; later simanim return to Amalek as memory, imagination, and inner accusation. These themes are interwoven with Rosh Chodesh, Shabbat, the enduring promise to Jacob, the authority of the Sages, and Israel's place among the nations.

The final stretch of Volume I moves toward the Days of Awe and the inner structure of Israel. The shofar becomes an instrument of awakening and remembrance; the patriarchs become a pattern for the Rosh Hashanah service; Elul is read through the interrelation of world, year, and soul; and Israel is portrayed as one spiritual body in every generation. The volume closes with Torah, mitzvot, teshuvah, Shabbat, and Amalek—ending on the opposing roots of sacred remembrance and forgetfulness.

RESISEI LAYLA · VOLUME I

SIMAN 1 Torah as Companionship in a World of Toil

In a world of movement and distraction, Torah joins a person to the whole creation and provides the truest companionship; Shabbat reveals the rest beyond worldly toil.

Seif 1 - Torah as the Companion of Creation

Torah connects a person to all creation and sustains him through the toil and distraction of this world.

¹¹כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּבִרְכוֹת, הָאָדָם בְּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה צָרִיד לְצִוְוֹתָא – **Man in this world needs companionship**, – "כָּל הָעוֹלָם כְּלוֹ לֹא נִבְרָא אֶלָּא לְצִוֹת לְזֶה" – **"The**
ו): – just as they stated in Berakhot (6b):

entire world was created solely to accompany this one," and inferring from this that he requires the company of created beings. (עירובין 22.) – And our Sages of blessed memory taught (Eruvin 54a): "One who travels on the road without an escort should engage in Torah," and this entire world is termed 'walking on the road,' as our Sages of blessed memory expounded (Sotah 21a) on the verse 'When you walk, it will lead you, etc.' – in this world. So when one lacks companionship, he should immerse himself in Torah, for it is the blueprint of Creation and of all created beings, as they said in Bereishit Rabbah (parashah 1), and it turns out that he has the companionship of all Creation and the entire world. וּלְכָךְ נִקְרָא עוֹלָם. For this reason this world is called 'when you walk,' as they stated in Berakhot (11a): 'When you walk, etc.' – this refers to preoccupation with a mitzvah. And this world is entirely preoccupation, which is why the day of death is called in the Talmud 'his soul rested,' meaning he rested from his toil, for

1. **Berakhot 6b** — "The sum of the matter, when all has been heard: fear God and keep His commandments, for this is the whole man." What is meant by "for this is the whole man"? R. Elazar said: The Holy One, blessed be He, said — the entire world was created only for the sake of this one. R. Abba bar Kahana said: This one is worth as much as the entire world. R. Shimon ben Azzai says — and some report it in the name of R. Shimon ben Zoma — the entire world was created only to be a companion to this one. Rashi: "Only for the sake of this one" — that is, in order that this one be created; and "to be a companion" he renders by the Old French for keeping a man company. Maharsha: By its plain sense the verse should have said "hear it all" in the imperative, as it goes on "fear God"; but since it says "all having been heard," the verse is speaking in praise of the God-fearing man, and so the close of the verse, "for this is the whole man," must be his praise as well. The three Sages therefore do not disagree — each took up one of the three worlds. "The entire world was created only for this one" takes in even the world of the angels, which was created for the sake of man, who has free choice, so that he might earn merit; "he is worth as much as the entire world" is said of the middle world; and "the entire world was created only to be a companion to him" of the lower world, created only to attend upon him and do his service, as Ben Zoma said, "Blessed is He who created all these to serve me." Maharal (Nesivos Olam, Nesiv Yiras Hashem 1): R. Elazar's "the entire world was created only for this one" means, as was said above, that the world was created for the sake of the fear of Heaven. He is "worth as much as the entire world" because creation is due to the world on one ground, that it is the totality of the world, and due to the God-fearing man on a second, that he makes himself an effect subordinate to his Cause; the two grounds are equal, and so the two are equal. Ben Azzai held that neither may be said, for the Holy One, blessed be He, surely willed to create the world in its own right; rather the God-fearing man is the essence of the creation, being the effect for whom creation is fitting, and the rest of the world was created for his sake.

2. **Eruvin 54a** — R. Yehoshua ben Levi said: One who walks along the road and has no escort with him should occupy himself with Torah, as it is stated: "For they shall be a graceful wreath [livyat chen] for your head" (Proverbs 1:9). Maharsha: "For they shall be a graceful wreath [livyat chen]" — occupation with Torah gives him grace upon the road in the eyes of all who see him, as we say in the Wayfarer's Prayer, "and grant us grace and kindness ... in Your eyes and in the eyes of all who see us." Maharal (Tiferes Yisrael, ch. 62): One who walks the road needs an escort because he departs from settled habitation, which is the very substance of existence, for "He did not create it a waste, He formed it to be inhabited"; where existence is not, he has cause to fear that he will come to non-existence, and this is why they said that all roads are presumed dangerous. Now the Torah is the order of existence, so that when a man occupies himself with it he is joined and attached to that order, and it is this that guards him from all evil, that nothing outside the order should befall him. Therefore they said that if he has no escort he should occupy himself with Torah, for then he will certainly not be in danger.

'man is born to toil.' יו' בִּירוּשָׁלַיִם (פֶּרֶק ב' דְּבִרְכוֹת הַלְכָה ד', יז) – **And therefore they said in the Yerushalmi (Berakhot 2:4, 17b):** "אָנָּה מִן יוֹמֵי לֹא כּוֹנֵנִית", – **'In all my days, I never achieved full concentration,'** כִּי טָרְדָא הוּא הִיפֶךְ הַכּוֹנֵנָה כְּדֵאִיתָא בְּבִרְכוֹת שָׁם – **because preoccupation is the antithesis of focused intention, as brought in Berakhot there,** וּלְכֹךְ אִי – **and hence complete intention is wholly impossible in this**

3. **Sotah 21a** — And [Scripture compared] the Torah to light, to tell you: just as light protects forever, so the Torah protects forever. And it says: "When you walk it shall lead you; when you lie down it shall watch over you; and when you awake it shall talk with you" (Proverbs 6:22). "When you walk it shall lead you" — this is in this world. "When you lie down it shall watch over you" — this is death. "And when you awake it shall talk with you" — this is in the time to come. Rashi: "It shall talk with you" — it will plead your merit on your behalf. Maharsha: This verse, which immediately precedes "For the commandment is a lamp and the Torah is light," also speaks of the Torah and teaches that it protects forever: in this world "it shall lead you" — in the sense of giving you rest from all troubles; when you lie in the grave "it shall watch over you" against the beating of the grave; and in the World to Come "it shall talk with you," pleading on your behalf against the judgment of Gehinnom. As for Tosafot's difficulty — that by the Gemara's conclusion a mitzva too protects forever — a mitzva protects forever only in this world, whereas the Torah protects even in the World to Come from the judgment of Gehinnom, as the verse "and when you awake it shall talk with you" shows. Maharal (Chiddushei Aggados, Sotah 21a): The Torah is intellectual, and whatever is intellectual does not fall under time; therefore it protects forever, as befits that which is beyond time and has no change, whereas the mitzva, like everything physical, falls under time and comes to an end, and so protects only for the moment. And since light signifies complete existence — without light nothing has existence, which is why a blind man is considered as though dead — one who holds fast to the Torah, which is complete light, cannot be abandoned by it to nonexistence: in this world, where a man is a "walker" who has no rest and may do something that brings him to ruin, it leads him; after death, the time of dissolution, it guards him from loss and gives him existence; and in the time to come, when he returns to life, it gives him speech, which is life — "it shall talk with you." Rav Tzadok (Pri Tzaddik, Chanukah 10): Death stems from the first corruption of Adam, and its repair is through occupation with words of Torah, of which it is said: "When you walk it shall lead you" — this is this world; "when you lie down it shall watch over you" — this is death; "and when you awake it shall talk with you" — in the time to come. For then, at the resurrection of the dead, the clarification will be complete, [showing] that death was only like sleep in this world, as the Sages called death "when he lay down to sleep," and the dew of Torah revives him. Rav Tzadok (Yisrael Kedoshim 7): The world is full of turmoil and has no rest; therefore they said, "When you walk it shall lead you" — in this world, for this world is the time of walking, since "man is born to toil." But there are those whose toil is with knowledge and skill in deed, and whose walking is in holiness. The angels are called "standing," for they remain on the one level at which they were created, but man walks constantly from level to level and has no rest, like the righteous mentioned above — and this is truly the ultimate rest. Beis Yaakov (Vayeishev 5): One who has no words of Torah has none of the good itself, for through words of Torah a person is awakened to all good things, as they expounded: "When you walk it shall lead you" — in this world; "when you lie down it shall watch over you" — this is death; "and when you awake it shall talk with you" — in the time to come. In the time to come the Blessed One will fill the treasuries of Israel and reveal to their eyes the light hidden in the performance of the mitzvos, and then they will see that all the knowledge, intentions and lights Israel had in this world were like a dream compared to its interpretation.

4. **Berakhot 11a** — As it was taught: "When you sit in your house" — this excludes one who is engaged in a commandment; "and when you walk on the way" — this excludes a bridegroom. From here they said: One who marries a virgin is exempt, and one who marries a widow is obligated. ... If so, even one who marries a widow [should be exempt]! — This one is preoccupied, and that one is not. If the exemption is on account of preoccupation, then even one whose ship sank at sea [should be exempt]! And should you say that is indeed so, why then did R. Abba bar Zavda say in the name of Rav: A mourner is obligated in all the commandments stated in the Torah except tefillin, since "splendor" is said of them, as it is said: "Bind your splendor upon you" (Ezekiel 24:17)? — There [the bridegroom] is preoccupied with the preoccupation of a commandment; here [the mourner] is preoccupied with the preoccupation of an optional matter. Rashi: Rashi explains that the bridegroom needed a verse of his own because the exclusion drawn from "in your house" removes only one busy with the actual work of a commandment, while the bridegroom's is an occupation of the mind alone — he is thinking about the consummation of the marriage. On the resolution at the end: since all we are deriving here is an exclusion — "excluding a bridegroom" — it is enough that what the verse excludes be a preoccupation belonging to a commandment [and not preoccupation of every kind]. Rav Tzadok (Likutei Ma'amarim, festival discourses 13): One kind of sinking into forgetfulness of the Blessed One comes through the power of action — zeal and excessive effort in worldly affairs, the rich man with his money and trade, the ruler with his rule — until a man has not a moment's rest to take time to remember the Blessed One, for he is preoccupied and confused by his affairs. This is called Ashur, for Ashur denotes strength and power and also way and walking, which is preoccupation, as the Sages said on the verse "and when you walk on the way" that he is preoccupied.

world. וְלֵכֶן נִקְרָא שַׁבָּת "מַעֲשֵׂין עוֹלָם הַבָּא" שֶׁהוּא יוֹם מְנוּחָה. – **Therefore Shabbat is called 'a semblance of the World to Come,' being a day of rest,** וְעוֹלָם הַזֶּה זְמַן הַטְּרָחָא, – **whereas this world is the era of labor,** (עֲבוּדָה זָרָה ג.). – **as they taught (Avodah Zarah 3a): 'He who toiled on the eve of Shabbat, etc.'**

5. **Jerusalem Talmud Berakhot 2:4** — R. Yirmiah said in the name of R. Elazar: One who prayed and did not direct his heart — if he knows that he can go back and direct his heart, let him pray; and if not, let him not pray. R. Chiya the Great said: I have never in my days had proper intention. Once I sought to concentrate, and my mind wandered and I said: Who enters before the king first, the arkafta [a Persian official] or the Exilarch? Shmuel said: I counted chicks. R. Bun bar Chiya said: I counted courses of masonry. Pnei Moshe (s.v. "I have never in my days had proper intention"): It was because he was preoccupied with meditating upon Torah — and so with all those that follow. The "arkafta" is the alkafta, an official who ranks above the Exilarch, and his musing was whether those admitted before the king are presented from the lower rank upward or from the higher downward, since the alkafta precedes the Exilarch. "Courses of masonry" are courses of a building.

RESISEI LAYLA · VOLUME I

SIMAN 2 Intellect, Will, and the Gathering of the Soul

The mind and heart shape one another; sin fragments their powers, while divine help gathers the scattered faculties of the soul into integrated righteousness.

Seif 1 - Intellect, Will, and Inner Integration

Mind and desire shape one another, while divine help gathers the soul's scattered powers into wholeness.

הַשֵּׁכֶל וְהָרָצוֹן הֵם שְׁנֵי מְנַהֲגֵי הָאָדָם – **The intellect and the will are the two governors of man,** (דלגן אָמְרוּ בִּירוּשְׁלָמִי סוּף פֶּרֶק קָמָא דְּבִרְכוֹת (ט) – **which is why they said in the Yerushalmi at the end of the first chapter of Berakhot (9b):** "אֵי אֵת יְהִיב עֵינָא וְלִבָּא לִי, אָנָּא יָדַע דְּאֵת דִּילִי" – **'If you give your eye and your heart to Me, I know that you are Mine.'** רָצָה לֹאמַר עֵינֵי הַשֵּׁכֶל – **'Eye' denotes the eyes of intellect,** (עֲבוּדָה זָרָה כח:) – **yet they stated (Avodah Zarah 28b):** **'The sinews of the eye are dependent on the heart,'** כִּי הָעֵינֶיךָ – **for the heart is primary, as 'from it flow the springs of life.'** הַלֵּב כִּי מְמַנּוּ תוֹצְאוֹת חַיִּים – **And intellect is drawn after desire,** (שְׁמוֹת כג, ח) – **as it is written (Exodus 23:8):** **'For bribery blinds, etc.,'** – **because the will bends the intellect.** (יֻמָּא עב:) – **Regarding this they said (Yoma 72b):** **'Why is there a purchase price... when there is no heart?'** – **Nevertheless, they also said (Bemidbar Rabbah 10:2):** **'The eye sees and the heart covets,'** – **as it is written (Yoma 72b):** **'The eye sees and the heart covets,'**

– showing that intellect generates desire. יז (אבות פֿרָק ג, יז): – And concerning this they taught (Avot 3:17): "אם אין חכמה אין יראָה, אם אין יראָה אין חכמה" – 'If there is no wisdom, there is no fear; if there is no fear, there is no wisdom,' והא שְׁנֵיהֶם קְשׁוּרִים יַחַד זֶה בָּזֶה וְהָא בְּלֹא הָא לֹא סָגִי. – the two being bound together such that neither can function without the other. – And it is written: 'My father and my mother have forsaken me, etc.,' – for as is known, 'father and mother' represent brain and heart, ושְׁנֵיהֶם עֲזָבוּנִי בְּעוֹנוֹתַי, – and both abandon a person through sin: חכמה ואין בינה בעידן דִּיצָר הָרַע, – there is neither wisdom nor understanding in the hour of the evil inclination (כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ נְדָרִים לֵב, – and none remembers the good inclination (as noted in Nedarim 32b), – leaving us devoid of intellect and worthy will. – ואין לנו שְׁכָל וְלֹא רָצוֹן, – Yet nonetheless, 'the Lord will gather me,' – רק מְכַל מְקוֹם "ה' יֹאסְפֵנִי. – for the Holy One, blessed be He, assists man and prevails for him even in the final generations, "בְּעֵינֵי" אָמַר לְאוֹמֵן שֶׁעֲשָׂאֲנִי כְּמֵה מְכוּעָר וְכוּלִי, – similar to: 'Tell the artisan who made me, how ugly is, etc.' (Ta'anit 20b); והקדוש and the Holy One, blessed be He, is the artisan Who made us thus, – בְּלֹא שְׁכָל וּבְלֹא בִינָה שֶׁבֶלֶב וְרָצוֹן, – without intellect, without understanding in the heart, and without holy desire. – הוּא יֹאסְפֵנוּ – פִּירוּשׁ אֲסִיפָה הוּא קְבוּצַת הַנִּדְחִים. – "וְיִהְיֶה כָּל עֵינָר הַיְשׁוּעָה" וְקִבְצַת נִדְחֵינוּ וְגוֹמַר, – He will gather us' – meaning gathering is the assembly of the dispersed, – שֶׁל כָּל פֶּרֶט נֶפֶשׁ – and that is the essence of salvation: 'and gather our dispersed, etc.,' – אם יְקוּבְצוּ נִדְחָיו, כָּל חִלְקֵי נֶפֶשׁוֹ לְמִקּוֹם אֶחָד – concerning each individual soul – it becomes righteous and redeemed. – הוּא צְדִיק וְנוֹשָׁע.

RESISEI LAYLA · VOLUME I

SIMAN 3 Sleep, Soul, and Spiritual Exchange

Sleep resembles death and exposes the soul to spiritual exchange; entrusting oneself to Hashem through Bedtime Shema preserves and redirects these forces toward good.

Seif 1 - The Soul during Sleep

Sleep opens the soul to spiritual exchange, and Bedtime Shema entrusts it safely to Hashem.

שְׁהִי, – **During sleep, it is possible for the soul to be exchanged,** – **בְּשֵׁינָה אֶפְשָׁר לְנִשְׁמָה לְהִתְחַלֵּף** – **for our Rabbis of blessed memory expounded in Shocher Tov (Psalm 25) on the verse 'They are new every morning, etc.,'** – **that the Holy One, blessed be He, does not exchange souls,** – **שֶׁאֵין הַקָּדוֹשׁ בְּרוּךְ הוּא מְחַלֵּף הַנִּפְשוֹת** – **inferring from this that an exchange is indeed possible,** – **רַק שֶׁהַקָּדוֹשׁ בְּרוּךְ הוּא נֶאֱמָן וְאֵין מְחַלֵּף פְּקֻדּוֹתָיו** – **only that the Holy One, blessed be He, is trustworthy and does not switch deposits entrusted to Him.** – **וְזֶהוּ מִי שֶׁמִּפְקִיד** – **This applies to one who commits his soul into the hand of the Holy One, blessed be He, saying 'Into Your hand I commit, etc.,'** – **בִּידוֹ שֶׁל הַקָּדוֹשׁ בְּרוּךְ הוּא שְׂאוֹמֵר "בְּיָדְךָ אֶפְקִיד וְגוֹמֵר** – **but for one who regards everything as chance and nature running its course, it can be exchanged.** (בְּבִרְכוֹת נז): **"שֵׁינָה אֶחָד מִשְׁשִׁים וְאַמְרוּ (בְּבִרְכוֹת נז):** – **כְּמוֹ אַחֲרֵי הַמּוֹת** – **And they taught (Berakhot 57b): 'Sleep is one-sixtieth of death,'** – **וְזֶה צָדִיק – נוֹטֵל חֶלְקוֹ": (חֲגִיגָה טו** – **just as after death we maintain (Chagigah 15a):** – **וְחֶלֶק חַיִּירוֹ בְּגֵן עֵדֶן, נִתְחַיֵּב רָשָׁע וְכוּלֵי**

כך יוכל להיות', and the portion of his peer in Gan Eden; if a wicked person is found guilty, etc., ' – שיתחלף חלק הטוב שבנפש רשע יגיע לאחר הזוכה – so too can it happen during sleep – בשינה – that an exchange occurs where the spark of goodness in the soul of the wicked is transferred to another who merits it, – והוא יקלוט הרע שבחבירו. – while he absorbs the evil in his counterpart. – Concerning this they described the ways of the wicked who would arise early in the morning to pursue evil, etc., – whereas conversely it is stated (Berakhot 16b): 'May we awaken and find the yearning of our heart directed toward You, etc.' – "שינה לרשעים הנאה להם לפי דרכם והנאה לעולם והו שאמרו (סנהדרין עא): – And this explains what they stated (Sanhedrin 71b): 'Sleep for the wicked is beneficial for them in their way, and beneficial for the world.' – וההיפך בצדיקים – The reverse is true for the righteous, – הטוב הוא, – for even though he absorbs that good, it is nonetheless deeply entwined with much evil from its original source and requires refinement and rectification; ולכך רע להם ורע לעולם שקולט הטוב מנבראי – hence it is detrimental for them and detrimental for the world, since he absorbs that good from the creatures of the world during sleep. – והעצה לשניהם הוא קריאת שמע. – The remedy for both is the Bedtime Shema and one verse of divine mercy, 'Into Your hand I commit, etc.' (Berakhot 5a), – ואין רע יוצא מלפניו יתברך לשום בריה בעולם ועל כן הכל יהיה לטובה Before Him, blessed be He, to any creature in the world, and therefore all will be for the good.

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Resisei Layla

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Volume II · Simanim 43–58

AKIVA PUBLISHING

Introduction to Volume Two

Volume II continues with Simanim 43–58 and develops many of the themes introduced earlier, while concentrating more intensely on mazal and prayer, Israel’s hidden covenant, the shofar, teshuvah, Rosh Hashanah and Yom Kippur, Shabbat, Chanukah, Purim, and the relationship between Written and Oral Torah. The opening simanim examine life, sustenance, children, and mazal; the capacity of prayer to reach beyond fixed spiritual roots; and the indestructible inner bond that distinguishes Israel even when that bond is concealed.

The next group of simanim traces affliction and consolation, the expanding voice of the shofar, and four distinct modes of divine apprehension associated with Abraham, Isaac, Jacob, and David. Creation and the songs of Shabbat are then read as a seven-day spiritual structure, followed by reflections on love, fear, and the true will of Israel. Teshuvah and the Great Shofar lead directly into Rosh Hashanah as a return to primordial divine thought and to the awakening that moves from below and from above.

Purim and the Days of Awe occupy the center of the volume. Siman 52 gives an extended treatment of Amalek, Haman, Moshe, da’at, keter, longing, speech, and the birth of Oral Torah; Siman 53 turns to Adar, joy, remembrance, and hidden da’at. Siman 54 then presents a broad meditation on Rosh Hashanah and Yom Kippur: the covered moon, sanctification of the festivals, repentance, free will, fear, salvation, atonement, and the future transformation of the evil inclination.

The concluding simanim move from Shabbat’s blessing and holiness to Chanukah and the living character of Oral Torah. Siman 56 is an extended inquiry into writing, speech, prophecy, sages, Scripture, and the unique inner wisdom of Israel; Siman 57 examines Greek translation and intermixture as a problem of clarification. The final siman returns to Purim and Adar, showing holiness precisely within concealment and bringing the two-volume work to a close through covenant, peace, and hidden divine providence.

RESISEI LAYLA · VOLUME II

SIMAN 43 Life, Sustenance, Children, and Mazal

The three fundamental human needs are governed by exact justice as expressed through the soul's supernal root; prayer can reach that level and reshape its flow.

Seif 1 - Children, Life, Sustenance, and Mazal

Exact judgment governs the three basic human needs through the soul's supernal root known as mazal.

צִוְרֵךְ הָאָדָם בְּעוֹלָם יְדוּעַ שֶׁהֵם שְׁלֹשָׁה דְּבָרִים – **Man's fundamental needs in this world are known to be three things:** חַיִּים, וְקִיּוּם הַחַיִּים דִּהְיֵנוּ מְזוּנֵי – **life, the preservation of life—namely sustenance (mezonei)—** וְהַהֲמָשְׁכָּה לְדוֹרוֹת דִּהְיֵנוּ בְּנֵי – **and continuity across generations—namely children (banei).** ¹¹וְאָמְרוּ זְכוּרֵנוּם לְבָרְכָה (מוֹעֵד קָטָן כח. – **And our Sages of blessed memory stated (Moed Katan 28a):** "דְּלָאוּ בְּזִכְוֹתָא תְּלִיא מְלֵתָא אֶלָּא בְּמִזְלָא תְּלִיא מְלֵתָא", – **"the matter depends not on merit, but rather on mazal,"** וְלִכְאוּרָה זֶה נִגְדַּר הַמְּבָאָר בַּתּוֹרָה וּבְדִבְרֵי – **and seemingly this contradicts what is explained in the Torah and in the words of our Sages in numerous places,** דְּהַכֵּל בְּמִשְׁפָּט, – **that everything is governed by exact justice,** וּבִרְאֵשׁ הַשָּׁנָה אָדָם נִדּוֹן עַל כָּל זֶה, – **and on Rosh Hashanah a person is judged regarding all of these,** וּמִתְפַּלְלִין בְּכָל יוֹם תְּמִיד עַל שְׁלֹשָׁה אֵלֶּה, – **and we pray every single day continually for these three necessities.** ²²וְהִגֵּם ד' שְׁכָר מִצְוָה בְּהַאי עֲלֵמָא לִיכָא" (קִדּוּשִׁין לט. – **And even though "there is no reward for a mitzvah in this world" (Kiddushin 39b),** הֵינּוּ

וּמִשְׁלֵם הָעֶנֶשׂ – "ד"סְבִיבְיוֹ וְשִׁעְרָה מְאֹד – signifying that "around Him it storms exceedingly,"
 וְכֵן הָיָה שֶׁמִּי שֶׁיֵּשֶׁתּוֹק לְעֵתִיד לְבֹא כִּדְּוָע – so that retribution is exacted in this world while

1. **Moed Katan 28a** — Rava said: Length of life, children, and sustenance do not depend on merit but on fortune. For Rabbah and R. Chisda were both righteous sages: this one would pray and rain would come, and that one would pray and rain would come. R. Chisda lived ninety-two years, Rabbah lived forty. In R. Chisda's house there were sixty wedding feasts; in Rabbah's house, sixty bereavements. Tosafos (s.v. "rather, it depends upon fortune"): They asked in Tosafot: but we said at the end of Shabbat that "Israel is not subject to a constellation"! One may answer that sometimes a man's lot is changed, as in the cases there, and sometimes it is not changed — as is said in Taanit concerning R. Elazar ben Pedat, to whom it was said: Would it please you that I destroy the world, so that perhaps you might be created anew at an hour of sustenance? Tosafos (s.v. "sixty wedding feasts"): Some explain that the number is not meant exactly. Maharsha (Chidushei Agadot, s.v. "it depends upon fortune"): Tosafot's answer — and in Tosafot at Shabbat it is more explicit — is that "Israel is not subject to a constellation" means that by great merit one's fortune is changed. And so it is proved from our own passage, for Rava asked for Rav Huna's wisdom and Rav Chisda's wealth, which are matters fixed by the decree at birth, since the angel sets up the drop and asks whether it shall be wise or foolish, rich or poor; perforce one must say that by an abundance of pleading for mercy from Heaven, as Rava did, the decree and the constellation under which a man was born can be annulled. Maharal (Derech Chaim 4:9): If we see one who is not a wholly righteous man, and he is a poor Torah scholar, this too has its cause: his ill fortune brings it about, for "life, children and sustenance do not depend upon merit." And even of a wholly righteous man one may say the same, that his ill fortune is the cause — as we find with R. Elazar ben Pedat in Taanit, whose fortune was so exceedingly bad that he had no sustenance at all. Rav Tzadok (Dover Tzedek, Miscellany 4:98): Although children, life and sustenance "do not depend on merit but on mazal" — one's hidden root — the whole Torah is full of reward and punishment in these three, for through merit the mazal changes, as one's deeds incline the hidden root. Yet sometimes both men are completely righteous, as with Rabbah and R. Chisda — which Rosh Hashanah attributes to Rabbah's descent from the house of Eli — and in truth this is what is called mazal: a hidden root drawn from one's forebears, though he himself did nothing. Effort still helped, but because of his mazal Rabbah needed more effort, while less sufficed for R. Chisda. Rav Tzadok (Likutei Ma'amarim, festival discourses 16): Children, life and sustenance comprise all of a person's needs in this world, where there is no reward for a commandment, and so they are decreed at the beginning of formation — "wise or foolish, strong or weak, rich or poor" — whereas "righteous or wicked," which is merit, is not. Yet the Torah promises all three as reward, for insofar as they bear on Torah and the commandments — long life to multiply Torah, children to serve God, a ready livelihood — they certainly depend on merit, which can change the mazal; what depends on mazal, decreed at formation, is given even where it does not aid the service of God. Rav Tzadok (Machshavos Charutz 15): Children, life and sustenance, which "do not depend on merit but on mazal," cannot be attained through prayer; hence they said that sustenance and matching a couple are as hard as the splitting of the Sea. Although we petition for sustenance in every prayer, that is for one born in an hour of sustenance or who prays at a time of favor; but for one not so born, like R. Elazar ben Peda, it depends on the supernal mazal in Atika, and prayer no longer avails — only Torah and calling to Him in truth, which is above mazal. Rav Tzadok (Pri Tzaddik, Balak 6): The root of all blessings is life, children and sustenance, which "do not depend on merit but on mazal"; the Zohar teaches that this is the attribute of Atika, which is "upon the Lord," as in "Hannah prayed upon the Lord" and "cast your burden upon the Lord" — the tip of the yod above the letters of the Name, alluding to Ayin [Nothingness]. When one merits the primordial light, the dew of Atika, one merits these three. Rav Tzadok (Takanas HaShavin 1): The souls of converts too were at Mount Sinai, as the Sages said, "their mazal was there" — and mazal is a person's root, as I have written elsewhere on "a person has a mazal" and on children, life and sustenance, which "depend on mazal." Beis Yaakov (Vayechi 45): Of sustenance the Sages said that it "does not depend on merit" — that is, not on the service a person performs with knowledge and clarity when his mind is clear and settled — "but on mazal": holiness must be engraved in his heart so permanently that it does not budge even when his knowledge and clarity are diminished. This is called mazal because service flows from him of itself, even without his awareness; sustenance must be drawn from a place above merit, from the supernal will called mazal.

reward is preserved for the World to Come, as is known; הזכות כפי המשפט הוא מוקדם
– nevertheless, it proceeds through strict justice according to merit. לברכה זכרונם לברכה³³
– Furthermore, our Sages of blessed memory stated (Shabbat 156a): "There is no mazal for Israel, עין שם
and this was raised as a difficulty by the Tosafot, see there. וזה הקשו התוספות, עין שם
– However, in truth this mazal does not refer to the celestial constellations known to astrologers, ד"אין מזל וכולי" על ידיעתם מצד מערכת המזלות⁴⁴
– concerning which they said (there) that "there is no mazal, etc., negating astrological influence, כי אצל בני

2. **Kiddushin 39b** — Rava said: Whose opinion is this? It is R. Yaakov's, who says: There is no reward for a commandment in this world. As it is taught: R. Yaakov says: There is not a single commandment written in the Torah whose reward is stated alongside it that is not dependent upon the resurrection of the dead. A man's father said to him, Climb the tower and fetch me fledglings; he climbed the tower, sent away the mother and took the young, and on his way back he fell and died. Where is the goodness of this one's days, and where is the length of this one's days? Rather, "that it may go well with you" — in the world that is wholly good; "that your days may be long" — in the world that is wholly long. Rashi (s.v. "that is not dependent upon the resurrection of the dead"): The reward stated alongside the commandment is not paid out here at all; it is stated in this way to make known to you that there is no giving of reward except in the world to come. Tosafos (s.v. "the mishna refers to a case where they make him a good day and a bad day"): Rashi's reading is difficult, for Rava's "Whose opinion is this? R. Yaakov's" implies that until now the mishna had not been established according to R. Yaakov, whereas on Rashi's explanation Abaye too had established both the mishna and the baraita according to him. Rabbeinu Tam therefore explains that both the good day and the bad day are in this world — sometimes a good day is made for the wicked man so that he may receive the reward of his commandments here, and a bad day for the righteous man so that his sins may be scourged away here — and this is not like R. Yaakov, who holds that there is no reward for a commandment in this world at all. Maharsha: Do not object from all the promises of the Torah, which can only be understood of this world. R. Yaakov concedes that the merit of the community and its good deeds bring upon it in this world too all the blessings and good things named in the Torah, and the reverse for the community's sin; he spoke only of the individual, whose reward, when his merits are many, is wholly in the world to come, since here evil is done to him in order to give him merit there — and conversely one whose sins are many is given good here in order to drive him from the world to come. Maharal (Chiddushei Aggados, Kiddushin 39b): Because the reward that belongs to the commandments is so great, their reward is not in this world; and one cannot say that He pays part of the reward of a commandment in this world and part in the world to come, for there is no payment by halves — hence there is no reward for a commandment in this world. R. Yaakov concedes that a wicked man does receive payment for a commandment he performed, since his reward is not so great; and because it is not great it can be discharged here, for a great reward cannot be given in this world, as they said, "one hour of contentment in the world to come is better than all the life of this world." Rav Tzadok (Divrei Soferim 25): Every commandment has its own reward, in the world to come and also in this world through its fruits: only the reward of the commandment itself "is not in this world," but a reward of fruits exists for every commandment, each in its own way — like "tithe so that you become rich," or children for sending away the mother bird. The Mishnah's "things whose fruits a person eats [in this world]" means only that for these one is assured of eating the fruits here, whereas for other commandments the fruits too may remain for the world to come. Rav Tzadok (Dover Tzedek, Kuntres Dover Tzedek, Erubin 4): Sins have a limit, as this world has a limit, but the commandments have none; therefore "there is no reward for a commandment in this world," since this world is bounded and the reward of the commandments has no bound. Rav Tzadok (Likutei Ma'amarim, festival discourses 7): The world to come is the cessation of activity, where the righteous enjoy the radiance of the Presence, and Shabbos is a taste of it; though "there is no reward for a commandment in this world," it is for this reason that Shabbos is called a "good gift." Rav Tzadok (Pri Tzaddik, Chanukah 13): Life does not depend on merit but on mazal because "there is no reward for commandments in this world"; but that is only the reward of a commandment done out of obligation, whereas what one does beyond the letter of the law the Holy One, blessed be He, repays in one's lifetime. That is why [the Gemara] lists acts of piety as the cause of long life. Rav Tzadok (Tzidkas HaTzaddik 171): "There is no reward for a commandment in this world" because the Holy One, blessed be He, gives a full load, and this world cannot receive that abundance of good at all; so here only sins are repaid, unless one merits tasting the fruit of his deeds or of commandments that bear fruit. Hence a time, place or soul "prepared for calamity" [pur'aniyos] is prepared for repayment [pera'on]: there the abundance of the repayment becomes calamity, as in the breaking of the vessels through excess of light. Beis Yaakov (Vayeitzei 6): Because "there is no reward for a commandment in this world," Israel holds only the markers [tziyunim] of the good, while the essence of the good is with the nations; in the future both will be joined together with Israel, as the Blessed One returns the essence to the place of the markers — hence the blessing "Who returns His Presence to Zion [Tziyon]."

יִשְׂרָאֵל הַכֹּל בְּמִשְׁפָּט עֲלִיוֹן יִתְבָּרֵךְ שְׁמוֹ כְּפִי כְּשֶׁרוֹן נִפְשֹׁתָם – **for with the children of Israel everything is governed by supernal divine judgment according to the fitness of their souls.** אָבֵל
 55: מִזְלָא זֶה הוּא מָה שְׁאָמְרוּ בְּרִישׁ בְּבֹא קָמָא (ב:) וּבִשְׁבָּת (נג)
 – **Rather, this mazal is what they stated at the beginning of Bava Kamma (2b) and in Shabbat (53b): "אָדָם דְּאִית לֵיהּ מִזְלָא", – "a human being who possesses a mazal," מְלָאךְ מְלִיץ – which Rashi explained: a guardian, advocating angel (malach meilitz).** – **Now, this advocacy**

3. **Shabbat 156a** — It was stated: R. Chanina says — there is a constellation that makes one wise and a constellation that makes one rich, and there is a constellation for Israel. R. Yochanan said: There is no constellation governing Israel. And R. Yochanan follows his own reasoning, for R. Yochanan said: From where do we know that there is no constellation governing Israel? For it is said, "Thus says the Lord: Learn not the way of the nations, and be not dismayed at the signs of heaven, for the nations are dismayed at them" — the nations are dismayed, but not Israel. Rashi: "A constellation makes one wise" — wisdom accords with the constellation, as it said [above] that one born under the sun will be bright and wise; "and there is a constellation for Israel" — for prayer and charity do not change the constellation. "There is no constellation governing Israel" — for through prayer and merit one's constellation is changed for the better. Tosafos (s.v. "there is no constellation governing Israel"): As for Rava's statement at the end of Moed Katan (28a), that children, life and sustenance depend not on merit but on the constellation: [the constellation] is nonetheless changed through great merit, though at times it is not changed; as it says in Yevamot, chapter HaCholetz (50a), "If he merits, they add to him; if he does not merit, they reduce for him." Maharsha: Tosafot wrote that through great merit [the constellation] is changed; but then, according to R. Chanina, who says there is a constellation for Israel, even great merit would not change it — yet all the Torah's promises, the blessings "if you hearken" and the curses "if you do not hearken," imply no such thing, but make [Israel's lot] depend on their merit or guilt. One may answer that the Torah's promises were said of the community of Israel, and the merit of the many certainly does not depend on the constellation at all; they dispute here only concerning the individual, R. Chanina holding that a constellation makes that individual wise or rich, and R. Yochanan that there is no constellation for Israel even for an individual — for he expounds "the nations are dismayed," but not Israel, even a single Israelite. Mahara! (Chiddushei Aggados, Shabbos 156a): [R. Yochanan] means that the constellation can be outweighed through mitzvot, even without any prayer — for that prayer avails is obvious, since the Blessed One does as He wishes in heaven and on earth. The community of Israel has in itself a supernal, separate level, as does the individual when he performs a divine mitzvah, and this stands above the constellation. This does not mean that the constellation has no hold on them at all — when it stands strongly against Israel they need great merit to outweigh it, as in Egypt, where it portended evil and the Blessed Name turned it to good for the merit of the forefathers — but that they are not wholly under the constellation as the other nations are.

4. **Shabbat 156a** — It was stated: R. Chanina says: A constellation makes one wise, a constellation makes one wealthy, and Israel is subject to a constellation. R. Yochanan says: Israel is not subject to a constellation. And R. Yochanan follows his own reasoning, for R. Yochanan said: From where do we know that Israel is not subject to a constellation? As it is stated, "Thus said the Lord: Do not learn the way of the nations, and do not be dismayed by the signs of heaven, for the nations are dismayed by them" — they are dismayed, but Israel is not. Rashi: "A constellation makes one wise" — wisdom accords with the constellation, as it said [above] that one born under the sun will be bright and wise; "and there is a constellation for Israel" — for prayer and charity do not change the constellation. "There is no constellation governing Israel" — for through prayer and merit one's constellation is changed for the better. Tosafos (s.v. "there is no constellation governing Israel"): As for Rava's statement at the end of Moed Katan (28a), that children, life and sustenance depend not on merit but on the constellation: [the constellation] is nonetheless changed through great merit, though at times it is not changed; as it says in Yevamot, chapter HaCholetz (50a), "If he merits, they add to him; if he does not merit, they reduce for him." Maharsha: Tosafot wrote that through great merit [the constellation] is changed; but then, according to R. Chanina, who says there is a constellation for Israel, even great merit would not change it — yet all the Torah's promises, the blessings "if you hearken" and the curses "if you do not hearken," imply no such thing, but make [Israel's lot] depend on their merit or guilt. One may answer that the Torah's promises were said of the community of Israel, and the merit of the many certainly does not depend on the constellation at all; they dispute here only concerning the individual, R. Chanina holding that a constellation makes that individual wise or rich, and R. Yochanan that there is no constellation for Israel even for an individual — for he expounds "the nations are dismayed," but not Israel, even a single Israelite. Mahara! (Chiddushei Aggados, Shabbos 156a): [R. Yochanan] means that the constellation can be outweighed through mitzvot, even without any prayer — for that prayer avails is obvious, since the Blessed One does as He wishes in heaven and on earth. The community of Israel has in itself a supernal, separate level, as does the individual when he performs a divine mitzvah, and this stands above the constellation. This does not mean that the constellation has no hold on them at all — when it stands strongly against Israel they need great merit to outweigh it, as in Egypt, where it portended evil and the Blessed Name turned it to good for the merit of the forefathers — but that they are not wholly under the constellation as the other nations are.

—, " (לב). על פסוק "אם יש עליו מלאך מליץ וגומרוכמו שאמרו בשבת, **certainly stems from merit**, as they expounded in Shabbat (32a) on the verse: **"If there be for him an advocating angel, etc.,"** — and this is also straightforward, for there is no defense advocacy except when undergoing judgment. ואמנם **Yet the primal root of this advocating angel belonging to each member of Israel**, ונאפלו לתינוק בן יומו, כדמוכח מהא דריש בבא קמא, **as proven from the opening of Bava Kamma**, אמ בן על כרחק אינו מלאך, **performance cannot be an angel created via the performance of mitzvot**. — Rather, רק דעצם נפש האדם, שהיא חצובה מכסא הכבוד שהוא למעלה מעולם המלאכים. **man's essential soul, being hewn from the Throne of Glory which transcends the angelic realm,** הנה יש בו מכל העולמות שתחתיו, **contains elements from all the worlds situated beneath it;** — **for as is known, every higher world encompasses all that lies beneath it**, שהרי ממנו הוא מתפשט ויוצא, **since from it lower reality expands and emanates.** יג. (והגיה יג. **And as our Sages of blessed memory stated (Chagigah 13a): "the feet of the Chayyot כנגד כלן, קרסלי וכולי":** **equal all of them, the ankles, etc.,"** — **and likewise whatever is above outweighs all that is beneath it.** (סנהדרין לח): **מהו כאמרם זכרונם לברכה (Sanhedrin 38b): when Hashem said "Let us make man," He addressed the angels; נעשה אדם,"** שאמר למלאכים **and since the Holy One, blessed be He, said to them "Let us make," לברכה**, **and since the Holy One, blessed be He, said to them "Let us make,"** **even though our Sages expounded (Bereishit Rabbah 8) that this teaches proper conduct to consult others, etc.,** ודאי לא נכתב דבר **Scripture certainly did not record a falsehood;** רק שהרוצה לטעות יטעה לחשוב שהאמירה **only that one wishing to err may err, thinking that the statement implies He required their partnership,** ובאמת אין זה אלא למוד דרך ארץ **whereas in truth it is simply a lesson in humility and derech erez,** על ידי **נעשה אדם,"** על ידי **Yet in absolute truth, Hashem's utterance "Let us make man" spontaneously instilled within him potency from all the worlds;** שהוא

5. **Shabbat 53b** — And is there such a thing as an amulet proven effective for a person and not proven effective for an animal? Yes: a person, who has a mazal, is aided by it; an animal, which has no mazal, is not aided by it. Rashi: "Mazal": his angel, who intercedes on his behalf. Maharsha (Chiddushei Halachos): This implies that an amulet proven for an animal is all the more effective for a person, who has a mazal; but then the Gemara's next question — "if so, what is 'this is a stringency with an animal'?" — is difficult, for that would itself be a stringency with an animal. He suggests, with some strain, that the Talmud takes it as settled that an amulet proven for an animal is likewise not thereby proven for a person. Rav Tzadok (Dover Tzedek, Miscellany 4:90): "A person has a mazal," which Rashi explains as the interceding angel, means his hidden root, from which he is wholly drawn; on it depend children, life and sustenance, the three general powers of the soul, and not on merit and deeds — so the main task is to rectify the root until it cleaves to the Lord even in its hidden aspects. Rav Tzadok (Takanas HaShavin 1): The souls of converts too were at Mount Sinai, as the Sages said, "their mazal was there" — and mazal is a person's root, as I have written elsewhere on "a person has a mazal" and on children, life and sustenance, which "depend on mazal."

and this is the primary meaning of "in our image"—encompassing all cosmic realms, as is known. – וְהַיֵּצֵר הָרָע הוּא מֵצֵד עוֹלָם הַזֶּה שֶׁבוֹ שֵׁיִךְ זְכוּת וְחוּבָה. – And the evil inclination stems from this physical world wherein merit and culpability apply; אָבֵל בְּמַלְאָכִים; – whereas among angels there is no evil inclination, as our Sages stated (Shabbat 89a), אָבֵל מִכָּל מְקוֹם יֵשׁ לָהֶם הַשְׁתַּדְּלוּת שְׁזָהוּ אֲמִירָת, – yet they nevertheless engage in spiritual exertion, which is the chanting of celestial song. – However, in the realm above them, even exertion is inapplicable, – "צְדִיקִין יוֹשְׁבִים וְכוּלֵי וְנִהְנִים וְכוּלִירֵק קְבֵלַת הָאָרֶז כְּטָעַם (בְּרִכּוֹת יז), – there being only the reception of divine radiance, as in: "the righteous sit crowned, delighting, etc." (Berakhot 17a), – which represents the root of man's soul in the ultimate heights. – ומֵצֵד שֶׁרָשׁוּ בְּעוֹלָם הַמַּלְאָכִים הוּא הַמַּלְאָךְ מְלִיץ, דְּהֵינּוּ כֹחַ נִפְשׁוֹ עֲצָמָה. – And from the perspective of its root in the angelic realm, that root is the advocating angel—namely the spiritual power of his own soul; שֶׁהוּא שׁוֹרֵשׁ הַנִּפְשׁ מֵהַ שֶׁנִּפְל לְגוּרְלוֹ; – therefore it is termed "mazal," representing the soul's root allotted to his portion at birth, – concerning which they taught (Niddah 16b): "This drop, what shall become of it, etc.," – רָצָה לומר: אֵיזָה נִפְשׁ יִשְׁפַּע בָּהּ, – meaning: which specific soul shall be channeled into it. (פְּרָשָׁה מ. – And as written in Shemot Rabbah (Parashah 40), – דְּכָל הַנִּפְשׁוֹת מֵאִפֶּת אָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן, – that all souls derive from the stature of Adam the First: – יֵשׁ בְּרִאשׁוֹ וְיֵשׁ בְּרַגְלוֹ, – some stem from his head and some from his foot, – וְלִכָּל אֶחָד כֹּחַ מִיָּחִד, – and each possesses a designated spiritual power. – מְלִיצַת הַמַּלְאָךְ, לִפִּי שֶׁעַל יְדֵי הָעֲבֵרוֹת "מִתִּישִׁין כֹּחַ פְּמִלְיָא שֶׁל מַעְלָה" (מְדַרְשׁ רַבָּה אֵיכָה פָּרָק. – And the angel's advocacy functions because through sins "they weaken the power of the Heavenly Host" (Eichah Rabbah 1:6); – וְאֵף דָּשָׁם בְּעוֹלָם הַמַּלְאָכִים אֵין זְכוּת וְחוּבָה; – and even though in the angelic world there is no intrinsic merit or guilt, – שְׁלֵמָטָה בֵּין הוּא כֹחַ הַשִּׁירָה וְהַשְׁתַּדְּלוּת דְּמַלְאָכִים, – nevertheless, corresponding to merit and guilt below, so is the power of the angels' song and striving, – רָצָה לומר מֵצֵד שֶׁהֵם עֲצָם שׁוֹרֵשׁ לְנִפְשׁוֹת, – meaning because they are the essential celestial root for the souls of Israel. – דִּיִּשְׂרָאֵל וְכֹחַ. – And the potency of advocacy corresponds directly to the force of one's actions, – הַמְלִיצָה הוּא כֶּפֶי כֹחַ הַמַּעֲשִׂים, – for there is no independent free choice in angels to elect to advocate and speak thus; – רַק שֶׁהוּא מְמִילָא; – שֶׁכְּשֶׁהָאָדָם זָכָא, הָרִי כֹחַ הַמַּלְאָכִי שֶׁבוֹ לְמַעְלָה בְּעוֹלָם הַמַּלְאָכִים הוּא מְלָאךְ, – it occurs automatically, – that when man acts righteously, the angelic facet of his soul above in the angelic world becomes an advocating angel. – וְשׁוֹרֵשׁ נִשְׁמָתוֹ בְּעוֹלָם הַכֶּסֶּם מְקַבֵּלֶת אוֹרָה כְּרָאוֹי לְהַשְׁפִּיעַ לְרוּחַ. – And the root of his soul in the World of the Throne receives its divine illumination to channel downward unto Ruach and Nefesh, – (יֻמָּא לט): "מְקַדְשִׁין אוֹתוֹ מְלַמְעָלָה כְּטָעַם, –

mirroring the principle: "they sanctify him from Above" (Yoma 39a). הכל תלוי זה: הכל תלוי – ונמצא כפי זה: הכל תלוי – Thus according to this perspective, everything depends entirely on merit, – בנכותא וזהו מצד – ובמצד [[and this reflects the vantage point of free choice in this world,] הבחירה דעולם הזה, [while from the vantage point of ultimate Divine Foreknowledge, everything depends on mazal, and in truth all is one], והלא כפי זה, ואמנם עם כל זה, – and yet with all this, in this world there are wicked people who receive what seems fitting for the righteous, and vice versa. – בעולם הזה יש רשעים שמגיע אליהם כמעשה הצדיקים, וכן להיפך. – And our Sages of blessed memory (ברכות ז:) על רשע שהשעה משחקת לו ואמר זכרונם לברכה מרום משפטיו: "Your judgments are on high, out of his sight," – וזהו כל משפטיו אמת, – "Your judgments are on high, out of his sight," – and how is this possible, when all His judgments are Truth? רק דבאמת אין לה אדם שאין בו – and as they said: "even the transgressors of Israel are full of mitzvot," – וכן אמרו: "אפלו פושעי ישראל מלאים מצות, – and "there is no righteous man upon earth who [does good and sins not]." – וכן אמר: "והעברות – וענין שקול הזכיות והעברות – And the weighing of merits against transgressions רק שקולים הם – כי אין בזה ידיעה כלל, – was already articulated by Maimonides in Hilchot Teshuvah: they are weighed solely in Hashem's knowledge; – and the matter is solid, for man has no comprehension of this calculation whatsoever; אף על פי שרבותינו – even though our Sages noted in various passages: "this mitzvah is greater than that one," – הוא בדרך כלל כפי משפט התורה, – that applies generally according to the Torah's legal framework, פרטי, – whereas supernal judgment regarding individual souls treats no two souls alike. – וזהו החלוק דמזל שאין תלוי בנכותא. – And this is the distinction of mazal not depending on generic merit: – דהגם דתרוניהו צדיקים גמורים ושוים במעשיהם – that even if both individuals are complete tzaddikim identical in their deeds, זה – מכיל מקום אצל זה, – nevertheless, in this one the power of that advocating angel is aroused by specific merits ממזל העליון – to pour down upon him an influx of children, life, and sustenance from his supernal mazal, ולא – אף על פי שעשה גם כן אותן זכיות, – while in that one it is not; אצל זה – performed those exact same merits, – nevertheless, when judged according to the unique root of his mazal, he is evaluated differently. – And likewise conversely among the wicked: there are instances of "Your judgments are on high," – וכן להיפך ברשעים: יש ד"מרום משפטיו שאין כח במדת משפט לדונו על רשעתו באותה – where strict justice lacks the immediate mandate to punish him during

מצד איזה זכות המרעיש כנגדם ומחפה על הכל לפי, *that hour when fortune smiles upon him*, המשפט השעה – *owing to some extraordinary merit that clamors on his behalf and shields everything for that hour's judgment*. והדברים ארפים בדרך המשפט שלמעלה, דברים שהם כבשונו. – *And these matters are vast concerning the supernal pathways of judgment, touching the deep secrets of the cosmos*. – *And the guiding rule is: everything proceeds by exact justice*, והכלל: דהכל במשפט, – *and with all that, it remains dependent upon mazal*— *for the judicial evaluation of merits and debts regarding the drawing down of children, life, and sustenance in this world is determined by the soul's mazal*.

Seif 2 - Prayer above Mazal

Prayer reaches beyond the soul's fixed root, while Purim's mitzvot draw Torah, life, sustenance, and continuity into the world.

As for prayer, concerning which our Sages of blessed memory said (Berakhot 6b), *that it is among the matters standing at the height of the world*, והיינו במקום המזל שהוא מרום מענין העולם, *this means at the level of mazala, the soul's supernal root, which transcends the affairs of this world, as mentioned*. – *Prayer brings about changes in mazala*; – *and this is the entire foundation of prayer: mazala receives and delights in the radiance of the Divine Presence*, – *whereas prayer is addressed to the One who bestows that abundance, blessed be His Name*. – *According to the strength of the abundance bestowed from above*, וזה כל שורש ענין התפלה, *so are the changes in children, life, and sustenance, contrary to what one's mazal would otherwise determine*. – *Although these depend on mazala*, – *this means that through prayer, which increases the abundance, his own mazal consequently bestows upon him what he previously lacked*. – *Yet even this still depends on mazala*, ואולם גם זה עדיין תלוי במזל, *as they said (Midrash Tanchuma, Miketz 9): there are appointed times for prayer*. ואין לך שהרבה. – *No one prayed more than Moshe Rabbeinu, peace be upon him, yet his request was not granted*. כי גם קבלת השפע הוא רק כפי הראוי לפי. – *For receiving the abundance, too, is limited to what is fitting for one's root and portion above*; – *and sometimes a person cannot receive anything further at all*. – *In this, too, there are many*